



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 1: Foundations of Cognitive Psychology

Cognition as a System

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Cognition as a System

Cognition means the set of processes by which we handle information. It includes how sensory input is taken in, organised, stored, recovered, and used. Think of it as a chain, not a single step.

From Sensation to Thinking

Sensation is raw input from the senses. Perception organises that input into something meaningful. Attention selects what to focus on. Memory holds and later finds information. Thinking and problem solving use information to decide or act.

Example: you hear a boda horn (sensation), recognise danger (perception), focus on the road (attention), remember the junction (memory), and choose when to cross (thinking).

How Psychologists Study the Mind

Cognitive psychologists use experiments, careful observation, and sometimes brain-related research. They may measure reaction time, accuracy, or what people remember after a task. You can already apply the same questions to your own study: what did I pay attention to, how did I try to remember this, and what cue helped me recall it later?

Reflect: Which stage in the path (attention, memory, or thinking) causes you the most difficulty during revision?

Closing

Module 1 is complete. Module 2 focuses on human learning.